

magic number that dictates your interest rate, your fees, your financial everything; and the credit score is the direct result of whatever is on that credit report.

Before we go any further, let me give you the contact information for what the industry calls the “big three”:

- ✓ Equifax
P.O. Box 740241
Atlanta, GA 30374
1-800-685-1111
www.equifax.com
- ✓ TransUnion
P.O. Box 2000
Chester, PA 19022-2000
1-800-916-8800
www.transunion.com
- ✓ Experian
P.O. Box 2104
Allen, TX 75013
1-888-397-3742
www.experian.com

Just Get It

Each agency gives one freebie credit report per year. Get yours. Order online, by mail, or request it over the phone. Or you can order them all at once with the “Annual Credit Report Request Form.” The name is self-explanatory, and it is free. Using the annual request also allows them all to know that you have gotten your one free report for the year, and now you will have to wait twelve months to use the annual service again.

The form is available on <http://ftc.gov/credit> and www.annualcreditreport.com or by mail at Annual Credit Report Request Service, P.O. Box 105281, Atlanta, GA 30348-5281. Or give them a ring at their toll-free number: (877) 322-8228.